

1 Kings 8:27

But will God<sup>H430</sup> indeed dwell<sup>H3427</sup> on the earth? behold, the heaven<sup>H8064</sup> and heaven<sup>H8064</sup> of heavens<sup>H8064</sup> cannot contain thee; how much less this house that I have builded?

Parallel passages

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| 2 Chronicles 6:18 | But will God in very deed dwell with men on the earth? behold, heaven and the heaven of heavens cannot contain thee; how much less this house which I have built!                           |
| 2 Chronicles 2:6  | But who is able to build him an house, seeing the heaven and heaven of heavens cannot contain him? who am I then, that I should build him an house, save only to burn sacrifice before him? |

Parallel accounts of the same events

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| Solomon blesses the congregation | I Kings 8:12-21 | II Chronicles 6:1-11  |
| Solomon's prayer                 | I Kings 8:22-53 | II Chronicles 6:12-42 |

Cross-references

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| Acts 7:48-50<br>Howbeit the most High dwelleth not in temples made with hands; as saith the prophet, [49] Heaven is my throne, and earth is my footstool: what house will ye build me? saith the Lord: or what is the place of my rest? [50] Hath not my hand made all these things?                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                               | Isaiah 66:1-2<br>Thus saith the LORD, The heaven is my throne, and the earth is my footstool: where is the house that ye build unto me? and where is the place of my rest? [2] For all those things hath mine hand made, and all those things have been, saith the LORD: but to this man will I look, even to him that is poor and of a contrite spirit, and trembleth at my word. |
| Acts 17:24-28<br>God that made the world and all things therein, seeing that he is Lord of heaven and earth, dwelleth not in temples made with hands; [25] Neither is worshipped with men's hands, as though he needed any thing, seeing he giveth to all life, and breath, and all things; [26] And hath made of one blood all nations of men for to dwell on all the face of the earth, and hath determined the times before appointed, and the bounds of their habitation; [27] That they should seek the Lord, if haply they might feel after him, and find him, though he be not far from every one of us: [28] For in him we live, and move, and have our being; as certain also of your own poets have said, For we are also his offspring. | John 4:23-24<br>But the hour cometh, and now is, when the true worshippers shall worship the Father in spirit and in truth: for the Father seeketh such to worship him. [24] God is a Spirit: and they that worship him must worship him in spirit and in truth.                                                                                                                   |

- The study verse occurs during a prayer of Solomon
1. Solomon builds the temple in Jerusalem and properly moves the ark of the covenant into the new temple from the tabernacle.
  2. There is a “dedication ceremony”
  3. Solomon blesses the congregation of Israel and God
  4. Solomon’s prayer
  5. Solomon blesses the congregation of Israel
  6. 142,000 cattle are offered as sacrifices (oxen and sheep)
  7. A 14-day feast occurs
- Take note and keep in mind that the study verse appears in a prayer and the format of that prayer follows the model that Jesus gave to us in [Matthew 6:9-13](#). The *general* format of the model prayer is as follows:
    - Praise ([1 Kings 8:22-28](#))
    - Ask ([1 Kings 8:29-50](#))
    - Praise ([1 Kings 8:51-53](#))
  - [1 Kings 8:27](#) occurs during the first “praise” section of Solomon’s prayer.
  - Solomon, in his wisdom gifted to him by God knew that God could not be contained within His own creation which included the temple that He enabled Solomon to build.
  - Solomon compares the heaven (the sky) and the heaven of heavens (the sky of skies, or the sky above the sky) to the magnificent temple that he built and acknowledges that if the former can’t contain God how much less could the latter contain God?
  - This acknowledgement of the truth simultaneously exalts and praises God.

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| H430  | <p>אֱלֹהִים 'êlôhîym, el-o-heem'; plural of H433; gods in the ordinary sense; but specifically used (in the plural thus, especially with the article) of the supreme God; occasionally applied by way of deference to magistrates; and sometimes as a superlative:—angels, × exceeding, God (gods) (-dess, -ly), × (very) great, judges, × mighty.</p>                                                                                                                                                                            |
| H433  | <p>אֱלֹהֶה 'êlôwahh, el-o'-ah; rarely (shortened) אֱלֹהֶה 'êlôahh; probably prolonged (emphatic) from H410; a deity or the Deity אֱלֹהֶה 'êlôwahh, el-o'-ah; rarely (shortened) אֱלֹהֶה 'êlôahh; probably prolonged (emphatic) from H410; a deity or the Deity:—God, god. See H430.</p>                                                                                                                                                                                                                                           |
| H3427 | <p>יָשַׁב yâshab, yaw-shab'; a primitive root; properly, to sit down (specifically as judge. in ambush, in quiet); by implication, to dwell, to remain; causatively, to settle, to marry:—(make to) abide(-ing), continue, (cause to, make to) dwell(-ing), ease self, endure, establish, × fail, habitation, haunt, (make to) inhabit(-ant), make to keep (house), lurking, × marry(-ing), (bring again to) place, remain, return, seat, set(-tle), (down-) sit(-down, still, -ting down, -ting (place) -uate), take, tarry.</p> |
| H8064 | <p>שָׁמַיִם shâmayim, shaw-mah'-yim; dual of an unused singular שָׁמַיִם shâmeh; from an unused root meaning to be lofty; the sky (as aloft; the dual perhaps alluding to the visible arch in which the clouds move, as well as to the higher ether where the celestial bodies revolve):—air, × astrologer, heaven(-s).</p>                                                                                                                                                                                                       |
| H3068 | <p>יְהוָה Yêhôvâh, yeh-ho-vaw'; from H1961; (the) self-Existent or Eternal; Jeho-vah, Jewish national name of God:—Jehovah, the Lord. Compare H3050, H3069.</p>                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                   |